Seagrass structure and bathymetry: field form

One form per transect. Pages 1–5 are used in the water (print on waterproof paper or copy onto the slate); page 6 is the post-site report, filled in the same day. Fill it in with Adobe Acrobat Reader (free): the Transect ID is then filled in automatically and the form is saved correctly. Nothing is collected. Method: Seagrass and Field transects pages of the SEASTRONG Field Processing Tools documentation.

1. Transect header

Study area (BZ / SC / FJ) Belize, Seychelles or Fiji		**Corridor (C1–C6)** Corridor number in the study area	
Transect ID e.g. BZ150327C1seagrass (automatic in Acrobat)	will autocompile	**Date** Survey date, as mm/dd/yyyy	
Operators Recorder (A) and photographer (B)		**Time zone of watch / phone** Clock used for the times, e.g. UTC-6	
Sensor 1 ID (seaward) Serial number of the seaward pressure sensor		**Sensor 1 position on tape (m)** Distance along the tape, e.g. 0	
Sensor 2 ID (landward) Serial number of the landward pressure sensor		**Sensor 2 position on tape (m)** Distance along the tape, e.g. 30	
GPS point at 0 m end (lat, lon) One approximate point at the surface above 0 m		**Bearing 0 → 30 m (°)** Compass bearing from 0 m towards 30 m	
Slack water time Expected slack water on the survey day			
Dominant species Species measured in the quadrats, e.g. Thalassia testudinum		**Other species** Other seagrass species present on the transect	

Meadow changes along tape (m: description) e.g. 0–6 m continuous; 6–10 m bare sand; 10–30 m patchy	

2. Before going in the water

- [ ] Around slack water; visibility and current OK for snorkelling
- [ ] 30 m tape laid on the bottom from sensor 1 (0 m, seaward) to sensor 2 (30 m), and on for 5–10 m
- [ ] Two 25 cm × 25 cm frames with marked points; graduated stick or depth gauge; camera
- [ ] Slate with mm ruler; plastic caliper; pencils
- [ ] Roles agreed: A recorder (depths, shoots, slate), B photographer (frames, photos, canopy height, thickness)

3. Depth and cover: every 2 m, at each sensor, and 5–10 m beyond the 30 m mark

Depth: graduated stick or gauge on the bottom next to the tape (m). **Time**: of the reading, for the tide correction. **Photo**: one vertical photo of the bottom from ~1 m above, tape in view (tick when taken). **Cover**: bare, patchy or continuous (optional, can be done later from the photo).

Tape (m)	Depth (m)	Time	Photo	Cover
0				
2				
4				
6				
8				
10				
12				
14				
16				
18				
20				
22				

Tape (m)	Depth (m)	Time	Photo	Cover
24				
26				
28				
30				
32				
34				
36				
38				
40				
sensor 1				
sensor 2				

4. Quadrats at the front (2.5 m): left (2 m), centre (at the tape), right (2 m)

Always on seagrass: if the planned spot is bare, move along the same line to the nearest seagrass and write the distance moved. **Canopy height**: undisturbed canopy at 3 points around the frame. **Photo 1**: canopy, straight down. **Photo 2**: shoot bases with leaves pushed aside. **Shoots**: 5 shoots of the dominant species nearest to the marked points, measured in place, longest blade held straight along the ruler. **Thickness**: all blades of one shoot held together at mid-length, plastic caliper.

Quadrat F-L front, left, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat F-C front, centre, at the tape	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat F-R front, right, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

4. Quadrats at the centre (15 m): left (2 m), centre (at the tape), right (2 m)

Always on seagrass: if the planned spot is bare, move along the same line to the nearest seagrass and write the distance moved. **Canopy height**: undisturbed canopy at 3 points around the frame. **Photo 1**: canopy, straight down. **Photo 2**: shoot bases with leaves pushed aside. **Shoots**: 5 shoots of the dominant species nearest to the marked points, measured in place, longest blade held straight along the ruler. **Thickness**: all blades of one shoot held together at mid-length, plastic caliper.

Quadrat C-L centre, left, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat C-C centre, centre, at the tape	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat C-R centre, right, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

4. Quadrats at the back (27.5 m): left (2 m), centre (at the tape), right (2 m)

Always on seagrass: if the planned spot is bare, move along the same line to the nearest seagrass and write the distance moved. **Canopy height**: undisturbed canopy at 3 points around the frame. **Photo 1**: canopy, straight down. **Photo 2**: shoot bases with leaves pushed aside. **Shoots**: 5 shoots of the dominant species nearest to the marked points, measured in place, longest blade held straight along the ruler. **Thickness**: all blades of one shoot held together at mid-length, plastic caliper.

Quadrat B-L back, left, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat B-C back, centre, at the tape	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Quadrat B-R back, right, 2 m	**Position on tape (m)**		**Moved to reach seagrass (m)**		**Photo 1 / Photo 2**	
	Canopy height (cm) 1 / 2 / 3		**Other species**		**Thickness: stack (mm) / blades (n)**	

Shoot	Blades (n)	Longest blade: length (cm)	Longest blade: width at mid-length (mm)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Post-site report

Filled in the same day, after downloading the data. Send it with the data to the data manager.

A. Survey

Transect ID e.g. BZ150327C1seagrass (automatic in Acrobat)	will autocompile	**Date** Survey date, as mm/dd/yyyy	
Filled in by Who fills in this report		**Survey complete (Y / N)** Depth stops and all 9 quadrats done	
Time in the water (h) From entering to leaving the water		**Visibility (m)** Estimated horizontal visibility	
Current None, weak or strong			

B. Data

Cover photos (n) Vertical photos taken at the 2 m stops		**Quadrat photos (n)** Photo 1 + Photo 2 of the 9 quadrats (18 expected)	
Photo folder name Transect ID + _photos		**Slate photographed (Y / N)** Photo of the slate saved with the data	

Data download link Link to the shared folder with all data, photos and this form	

C. Quality check (tick if a problem)

- ☐ Shoot bases not visible in some Photo 2
- ☐ Quadrats moved far from the planned position
- ☐ Depth stops missing
- ☐ Shoots or thickness missing in some quadrats
- ☐ Strong current or poor visibility during the survey
- ☐ Tide changed a lot during the survey

D. Deviations from the protocol, problems and notes